

Max Zimmer-Smith

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SUMMARY

My unique career journey, spanning digital storytelling, technical fieldwork, and customer service, has shaped my adaptability, resilience, and problem-solving skills. These experiences taught me how to thrive in fast-paced, collaborative environments and quickly learn new skills. Now, as a software developer, I build user-focused tools that simplify workflows and alleviate pain points, while contributing across Agile teams and aspiring to grow into a core maintainer and technical leader. I bring technical expertise in React, TypeScript, and testing frameworks, along with strong communication skills and a creative mindset inspired by my interests in emerging tech, Dungeons & Dragons, and LitRPG.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Company A

July 2024 - Present

Associate Software Engineer (full-time)

Delivering UI features as the sole front-end developer within a cross-functional Scrum team for a large-scale enterprise application used by thousands of UK & ROI agents to manage customer accounts. Leading accessible, business-aligned development in close collaboration with designers, product owners, and backend engineers, enabling faster and more effective customer support. Working towards Core Maintainer status for two key front-end repositories, while strengthening team capability by hosting Community of Practice meetings and streamlining onboarding through improved documentation.

Key Achievements

- Played a key role in the design and development of a new GraphQL aggregation layer, enabling a Google Cloud-based AI concierge service to securely access data from internal services.
- Refactored 10+ legacy components leveraging a modernised, internally developed UI component library; eliminating all accessibility errors flagged by Evinced.
- Review ~5 merge requests weekly across two key frontend repositories, pre-empting 90%+ of fixes and halving deployment times.
- Delivered full-stack React and Java features for a graduate project monitoring 1,000+ codebases, enabling Principal Engineers and Senior Developers to identify vulnerable dependencies and prioritise upgrade paths.

Company A

February 2020 - July 2024

Home Service Engineer (full-time)

Installed and maintained satellite TV and Fibre to the Premise services across North East Scotland, managing 6+ customer visits per day while ensuring safety, compliance, and high-quality service. Oversaw van stock, service, and MOT compliance, while proactively developing leadership skills by providing field manager coverage when needed.

Key Achievements

- Achieved 9+ CSAT scores consistently and upsold on 50%+ of visits.
- Maintained a sub-5% revisit rate across thousands of installations with zero safety incidents.
- Developed leadership skills as acting manager for up to 4 teams of 10–15 engineers, sustaining strong CSAT and KPI results.
- Awarded Network Operative Passport Scheme (NOPS) qualification for Fibre to the Premises installations on the Openreach Network, among the first engineers at Company A to do so.

Company A*Studio Instructor (full-time)***January 2019 - February 2020**

Designed and delivered interactive media production sessions for young people, using bespoke video capture and editing software and professional studio equipment to teach practical skills in an engaging, hands-on environment. Ensured sessions were inclusive and safe, and acted as a point of contact for school staff and visitors.

Key Achievements

- Delivered hands-on sessions to ~200 students per week, fostering creativity and technical skills.
- Secured 80%+ of unfilled bookings by contacting 300+ schools.
- Guided students with Special Educational Needs and Disabilities (SEND) and led tours/briefings for visitors, maintaining inclusive and compliant environments.

Company A*Retention Expert (full-time)***March 2016 - January 2019**

Provided customer support within the Broadband Centre of Excellence, handling high-volume calls and resolving complex service issues while balancing retention targets, upselling opportunities, and customer satisfaction. Supported team development through training and interim leadership responsibilities.

Key Achievements

- Achieved 70%+ retention rate across 100+ weekly calls.
- Achieved 9+ CSAT scores consistently while upselling on 50%+ of calls.
- Kept repeat calls under 1% by resolving complex issues, reducing escalations.

SKILLS

Technical Skills

- Proficient: React, TypeScript/JavaScript, HTML, CSS, GraphQL, Jest, Playwright, Git, Jenkins
- Familiar: Java, Spring Boot, Python, Flask, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, Docker

Agile Methodologies

- Scrum, Kanban, SAFe

Languages

- English (fluent), German (fluent), Luxembourgish (native), French (strong)

EDUCATION

University A*Master of Arts Single Honours - English - 2:1***August 2015**

- Member of AU Boat Club (Rowing), and AU All-Round Fighting Club (MMA).

University B*Bachelor en Cultures Européennes - English Studies***August 2012**

- Member of Shotokan Karate Asahi Prüm, Germany.